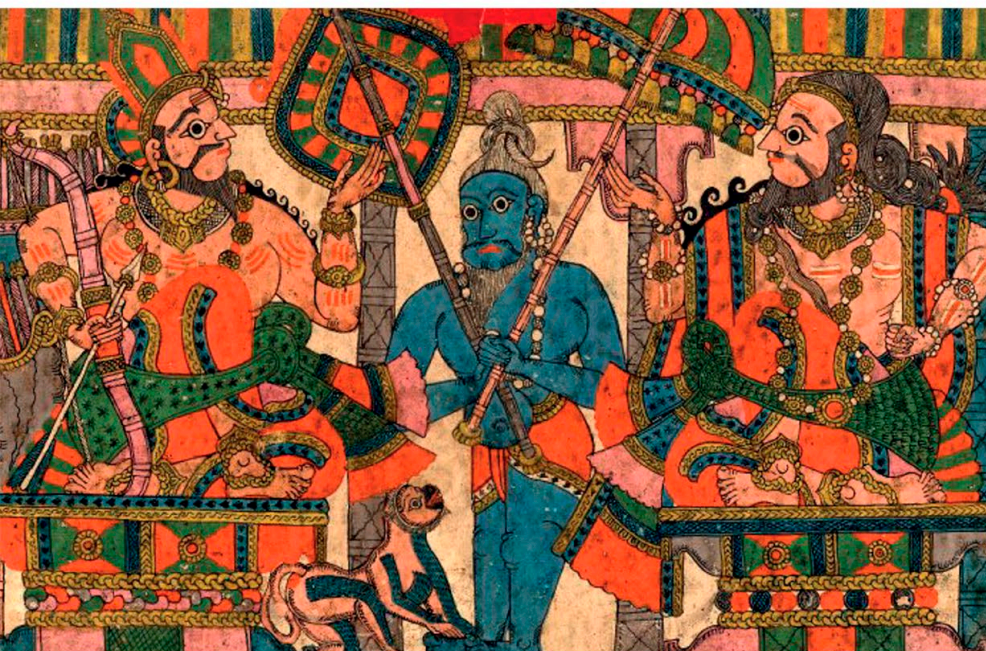




c. 800 BCE

VEDIC PERIOD

The composition of Sanskrit texts, the Brahmanas, and the first of the Upanishads, marked the beginning of what is known as the later Vedic period of the Indo-Vedic civilization of northern India. These sacred texts, with others, were arranged into collections, the four Vedas, which were the foundation for Brahmanic religions. The texts were also the cornerstone of the principles of the Kuru regional culture, influencing the development of its hierarchical social structure.

◀ The sage Vyasa talks to King Janamejaya of the royal Kuru clan, codifier of the Vedic texts

800 BCE

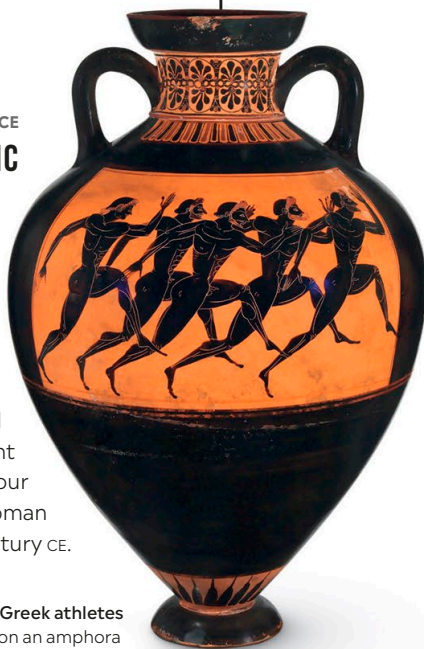
c. 800 BCE The Hellenic people

of city-states such as Sparta, Athens, and Thebes spread from mainland Greece to colonies around the Aegean

776 BCE
**FIRST PAN-HELLENIC
OLYMPIC GAMES**

According to tradition, Olympia hosted the first pan-Hellenic Games in 776 BCE. A religious festival and athletic competition, the games also had a political purpose, both fostering relationships between participating Greek city-states, and rekindling old rivalries. The ancient Olympic Games were held every four years, and continued even under Roman rule until the 4th century CE.

▷ Naked Greek athletes depicted on an amphora



771 BCE

**EASTERN ZHOU DYNASTY
BEGINS IN CHINA**

After the invasion of the Zhou capital, Haojing, by barbarians, the royal family were forced to flee eastward, making Luoyi the capital of the Eastern Zhou Dynasty. This heralded the beginning of a period of decline of the power of the Zhou kings, and a fragmentation of the region into more autonomous states. This first half of the Eastern Zhou dynasty became known as the Spring and Autumn Period (722–481 BCE), named after an official chronicle of the state of Lu, the *Spring and Autumn Annals*.

◀ The sword of Goujian, king of Yue, one of the hegemonies of the period

